



Gaming consoles are an essential part of your entertainment system these days

but very rarely on the Wii. On the other hand, the games available on the Wii will provide you with a gaming experience that is quite unique (or was till the motion controllers for the other consoles came out) and the games can be a lot of fun.

Multiplayer

Coming to the multiplayer aspect, there is a lot of rivalry here as well. While PSN does offer you a lot of features for free that come at a premium on Xbox Live, the service is crippled in terms of its social aspect. That said, paying for a PSN subscription will give you considerably less value than if you pay for an Xbox Live gold membership. Both services net you free games and access to Netflix and such (not relevant in India at the moment). The Wii is way behind in terms of a meaningful online experience, but then that is not the USP of the console in the first place.

Home entertainment

What about a complete home entertainment centre?

This is again a point of contention between the Xbox 360 and PS3. The PS3 offers you Blu-ray support out-of-the-box, and gives you a 1080p, 3D output. The Xbox 360 did get 3D support later, but it doesn't come with a Blu-ray drive. The Wii is worst off here, not supporting DVDs and only having support for SDcards and videos.

The Xbox 360 (if you bought the version that supports it) and PS3 have in-built HDDs and support a few popular formats; they can also access supported NAS drives.

Interface

If we're to consider the interface and the movie watching experience in general, the novel experience offered by the Kinect on the Xbox 360 is something that might appeal to a lot of people. The new dashboard with voice and gesture support can be a lot of fun to use, especially as you don't need a remote-control to take advantage of it. The PS3's interface isn't bad either, but it doesn't compare to the Xbox 360 in terms of its novelty and maybe even ease-of-use.

Motion controllers

The 3 consoles mentioned here all have support for motion-sensor based gaming of one form or the other. Which one is better depends on how you like to play, though the Kinect sensor for the XBOX360 has taken quite a lead in terms of its popularity, acceptance and versatility.

Stuff that doesn't matter

Some stores will advertise Netflix and Hulu support, etc. as advantages but the fact of the matter is that there is actually no proper support for those services in India.

Another aspect to consider is the hard disk. Both the PS3 and XBOX360 come with options for the inbuilt hard disk and if all you're looking for is extra storage for movies and photos, don't shell out more for the higher capacity drives. You can very easily buy external HDDs, format them in FAT32 and use them with your console at a fraction of the cost of getting an updated HDD (in terms of the price per GB).

Recommendations

If your primary focus is on gaming, choosing the right console depends almost entirely on what games you want to play. For movies and media, it's a tie between the Xbox 360 and PS3. The PS3 gives you Blu-ray and full HD, but despite lacking HD support, the Xbox 360 gives you a unique experience with the Kinect kit, that and a promise of tight integration with Windows 8 based devices in the future. The Wii was very popular but its popularity has waned over the years. It's still a very good device and perfect if you're looking for fun, family-friendly games, especially for kids.

As far as hand-held consoles go, your best (and only) option is the PS Vita. At a cost of almost ₹20,000, almost as much as a proper console, but the device is powerful and if you already own the PS3, an ideal companion.



The vast segment of graphics cards undergoes an upheaval every year with an entire family of cards being released by both competitors gradually through the year. This year we saw the NVIDIA 600 series and the AMD 7000 series being launched with some offerings of either series yet to release. In such an ever-changing market the best buy keeps on changing and we are gonna help you figure out what suits your purpose the best.

When talking about technology, nearly all the numbers matter but we will break it down into stuff that you need to be concerned about and things that you can let go of. Depending upon your usage you'll need to choose between Desktop graphics or Workstation graphics. The current choices are -